

Looking Back at 42 Years

by Peggy and Rick Johnson

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Harstine Island? We both grew up in southwest Washington, but didn't discover the island until friends invited our family to visit in the summer of 1967. We had just returned to live permanently in Seattle. The following summer, the five of us spent a week in that beachfront cabin, again reaching the island aboard the tiny ferry. We heard a rumor that Weyerhaeuser was planning a development at the north end.

The bridge was built, Hartstene Pointe was developed, and we visited in the Spring of 1971. We loved the clubhouse, the swimming pool, the contemporary design of the Island Houses. We greatly appreciated the land-use planning, with 3.5 miles of beach and acres of forest to co-own

and explore. A year later, new roads took us to "the Pointe", with magnificent mountains on two sides. By Memorial Day weekend of 1972, we owned a 300-model islandhouse and were all moved in.

Our three children have helped us reminisce and recall the early days:

- The Quadrant salesmen in their red jackets, their offices at the clubhouse, later at model homes. Our children remember the food they served. Peggy remembers the rainy weekdays when they entertained our two young sons with games of poker.
- The model islandhouses, furnished by Del-Teet, which we toured with visiting friends.
- The oysters which Quadrant had seeded on our beaches, so plentiful, for a few short years.
- The lifeguard and the swimming classes.
- The trees, which seemed so tall, but oh, how we've watched them grow!
- The friends our children made as they safely roamed the Pointe. Parents of these children often became our friends, too.
- An early Hobie Cat regatta, which covered our beaches with colorful sails (not the waters, however-no wind that weekend).
- The slow dredging of the lagoon, with the fill covering the North Pointe wetlands, creating the large play and picnic area.

- The forts which the children created in the forest as they followed the old logging roads, discovering huge wooden spools and other old logging equipment.
- The strange tasting, bad smelling water which ran from our taps and stained the toilet bowls (They said it was safe, and we drank it).
- The worker who was killed in the building of the pump station for the sewage treatment plant.
- The children riding the trails on their bicycles, before mountain bikes appeared and the trails were closed to bikes.
- Fishing off the old "T" dock, which had very little moorage-before Indian Cove was dredged.
- Finding the best clams in Indian Cove, and venturing out in our small sailboat to set traps for the red crabs.
- Discovering deer, foxes, a coyote and other animals, all truly wild creatures back then. The raccoons were the first to learn to beg from their new human neighbors.
- The dozens of relatives and friends who visited us, many deciding to buy or build here.
- The brave people who have served as Board Members over the years, making and keeping Hartstene Pointe a wonderful place to be.

In 1990 we moved to our new house on Promontory Road, designed and built by two young architects whom we met in the swimming pool, Mark and Peter Anderson. We continue to love this place, which has played such an important part in our lives, and we see the tradition continuing with our children and grandchildren.